HAGIA SOPHIA

Consecrated in 537 AD, Hagia Sophia - which means Holy Wisdom - was the largest building in the world, fireproof, with four immense pillars held together with molten lead which supported four arches and lesser domes, creating a space so overwhelming it seems to defy the laws of gravity. Indeed, people were scared to enter it at first in case the dome collapsed. The designs were drawn up by Anthemius of Tralles, a noted mathematician, and Isidorus of Miletus, the last head of the Athens Academy. Colour was provided by stone and marble brought from other parts of the Justinian empire: red from the temple of Boalbek and green from Ephesus. At one time it was bright with golden ornaments and chandeliers. With the Turkish conquest in 1453, it became a mosque, with the addition of the corner minarets, and many of the decorations were concealed with whitewash. These were gradually restored by Thomas Whittemore, of the Byzantine Museum of America, after the building became a museum on the instructions of Mustafa Kemal Atatürk in 1933.

EXERCISE 1: **Find words or** phrases **in the** passage which mean the same as:

	COLUMN A	**COLUMN B**
a)	officially declare an object or a building to be holy	
b)	knowledge or understanding of what is true and right	
c)	unable to be damaged by fire	
d)	extremely large	
e)	a tall column of stone, wood, etc., which supports something in a building	
f)	liquefied form of something solid, e.g. metal, which has been heated	
g)	a curved structure in a building, e.g. in the roof, above a door	
h)	smaller	
i)	a round roof, e.g. the roof of a mosque	
j)	causing a feeling of being small, helpless, and astonished	
k)	go against; refuse to obey	
l)	the force which makes things stay on or drop to the ground instead of staying in the air	
m)	well-known; admired	
n)	building used for worship	
o)	thing used for decoration	
p)	something hanging from the ceiling which consists of several branches of lights	
q)	hide	

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. Since 1933, Hagia Sophia . . . . . .

A) has had several minarets added
B) has been a mosque
C) has been the largest building in the world
D) has been a museum
E) has had some more pillars added

2. With its immense structure, Hagia Sophia . . . . . .

A) is the largest building in the world
B) has always frightened people
C) is still the biggest church
D) has survived several big fires in its history
E) was once unique in the world

3. We can conclude from the passage that . . . . . .

A) the materials used to build Hagia Sophia were brought from several places
B) the Byzantine Museum of America took charge of Hagia Sophia after a long struggle
C) the Byzantines had whitewashed most of the decorations in Hagia Sophia to conceal them from the Ottomans
D) most of the golden ornaments and chandeliers in Hagia Sophia were destroyed during the war
E) in 1933, Atatürk assigned Thomas Whittemore to restore the decorations in Hagia Sophia

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

1. The girl's face was partially ..... by an enormous hat.
2. Despite constant warnings, the children still ..... the notices not to swim in the river.
3. When she looked from the tenth floor apartment window she found the height so ..... it made her afraid.
4. The company's new ship is so ..... that it can carry over three thousand passengers.
5. He was found guilty of murder, but acquitted of several other ..... charges.